

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K 8 4

♦ -

♣ J 10 9 7 3 2

♠ Q 8 4 2

♥ Q 9 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ 8 6



♠ A J 9 6

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ J 10 8

♣ K 5

♠ 5

♥ A 3

♦ K Q 9 6 5 3 2

♣ A Q 4

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|------|-------|------|-------|

Pass

1♥

Pass

1♦

Pass

4♦

Pass

3♦

All Pass

5♦ by South

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

You open 1♦ and partner responds 1♥.

What is your next bid?

With 18 points you are too strong to rebid 2♦ but just right to jump to 3♦. Now partner raises to 4♦.

What is your next bid?

Your jump showed 16 - 18 points and partner invited you based on that range. He wants you to bid game if you are at the top. With 18 points you bid 5♦.

South plays 5♦. West leads the ♣J and East plays the ♣K.

**South plays 5♦. West leads the ♣J and East plays the ♣K.**

The ♣ lead was pleasant, it gave you a free finesse. But it didn't really give you a winner since you would have ended up taking the finesse yourself even without the lead. Still, it clears the position somewhat.

You can't get rid of the ♠ loser, nor can you get rid of the ♥ loser. By process of elimination then, you must get rid of the ♣ loser. You could ruff it in dummy, but the play to the first trick makes you a little worried about an over-ruff by East. You could ruff with the ♦A, but then if someone started with ♦J 10 8 you'd lose a natural ♦ trick.

First test the ♦s by playing the ♦K. West shows out and there goes your hope of ruffing the ♣ with the ♦A. You have one more possibility to try. Play the ♥A, then a small ♥ toward the ♥Q. If West holds the ♥K dummy's ♥Q will be promoted to a winner that you can dump your ♣ loser on.

As you can see, if you ruffed the third ♣ with a low ♦ East would over-ruff.

If you ruffed the third ♣ with the ♦A East would win a trump trick.

So you couldn't ruff the third ♣ at all, you had to discard it on something. And the only "something" that dummy had was the ♥Q.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ 7 6 4

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ A 9 7 2

♣ 8 6



♠ 10 3

♥ A J 9 5 2

♦ J 10 5 4

♣ 5 3

♠ A K Q J 8

♥ K 4

♦ K 3

♣ A K Q 4

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|------|-------|------|-------|

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

5♦

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♠ by South

This is definitely a 2♣ opening bid.

Partner responds 2♦, 7 points or less.

The formalities are over. Partner knows you have 22 or more points and you know he has 7 or fewer. Time to find a suit.

You bid 2♠ which partner raises to 3♠.

Partner's 3♠ bid is forward-going. With a complete bust he would have said 3♣ as a "second negative". So you use Blackwood. Partner shows one Ace and you bid the slam.

South plays 6♠. West leads the ♣J.

**South plays 6♠. West leads the ♣J.**

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Between the ♥ loser and the ♣ loser which one can you eliminate? Easy question, fast losers like the ♥A are tough to eliminate. Usually you work on those slow losers.

The logical way to remove that ♣ loser is to ruff it in dummy. But do it carefully. It would be silly to play ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q and then try to ruff the ♣4. That is just begging for an over-ruff. It would be better to just take two rounds of ♣s, then ruff the ♣4. But even that isn't the best.

First take two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K. Then play two top ♣s. Only then do you ruff the ♣4.

You only needed one trump in dummy to ruff your one ♣ loser, so that made it right to pull two rounds of trumps first.

It made no difference in tricks whether you ruffed the third or fourth ♣ so that made it right to ruff the third one.